

Tuesday, 21 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 26° 14°	MANCHESTER Overcast 24° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 24° 15°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Millions of people across the South East of England are facing a hosepipe ban, as South East Water introduces restrictions.

Customers in Sussex, Surrey, Hampshire, and Berkshire will be affected by the ban, which comes into force as the region experiences dry conditions.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

A pupil has been found not guilty of attempting to murder their history teacher after a stabbing incident in a classroom.

The teacher, Vicki Williams, was stabbed in her classroom at Milford Haven Comprehensive School. The verdict follows a trial that captured national attention.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Ryanair has reported a drop in profits, blaming the ongoing conflict in Iran for deterring passengers and increasing fuel costs.

The Irish airline stated that rising oil prices, with Brent crude surpassing \$90, significantly impacted their operational expenses. This comes as many airlines face economic headwinds.

BUSINESS · UK
- 4

Emergency services were called to the Port of Tyne after reports of a crane 'colliding' with a container ship, leaving one man injured.

Police confirmed that a man was injured in the incident. Investigations are now underway to determine the cause of the collision.

INCIDENT · UK
- 5

A drug dealer has been found guilty of exploiting a 14-year-old boy, coercing him into selling drugs across the west of Scotland.

The young boy was forced to distribute small samples of cocaine to addicts in various locations. This case highlights the vulnerability of children to criminal exploitation.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 Get ready for some serious muscle on your screens, as a former World's Strongest Man is set to become a Gladiator!

Tom Stoltman, a 6ft 8in athlete from the Highlands, will join the cast of the popular Saturday night show for its fourth series. He's sure to bring some incredible strength to the arena.

ON AIR – Do you think he'll be a fan favourite, or will the other Gladiators give him a run for his money?

TV · COMING UP

2 A new drama series is in the works, set to dramatise a major maternity scandal that shocked the UK.

The series will focus on Sarah and Jack Hawkins, who were among the first to raise the alarm about the issues. It promises to be a powerful and important watch.

ON AIR – Are there any real-life stories you think would make compelling television?

TV · COMING UP

3 Bruno Mars brought the house down at Wembley Stadium, marking his return to UK stages after an eight-year absence.

The star delivered a polished, hit-filled show, delighting fans with his signature sound and energetic performance. It was a night of pure entertainment.

ON AIR – What's the best concert you've been to recently, and who would you love to see live?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

4 Gracie Abrams has released her third album, capturing the pain and complexities of early adulthood.

The album features incisive and witty lyrics, though some critics suggest the production could be more dynamic. It's a relatable listen for many young fans.

ON AIR – What music are you listening to right now that perfectly sums up how you're feeling?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

5 A new documentary reveals the incredible impact Wham! had on people during their groundbreaking visit to China.

Andrew Ridgeley shares how their concerts changed lives in China, offering a fascinating look at the band's global legacy. It's a testament to the power of music.

ON AIR – Can you think of any other bands or artists who had a huge cultural impact in unexpected places?

DOCUMENTARY · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Spain have been crowned FIFA World Cup champions, beating Argentina 1-0 in a thrilling final that went into extra time.**

Ferran Torres scored the only goal of the game at the New York New Jersey Stadium, securing Spain's second World Cup title. It was a dominant performance from the Spanish side.

ON AIR – After a nail-biting final, what was your favourite moment of the entire World Cup tournament?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England have sealed a 2-1 ODI series win against India, with Ben Duckett hitting a record-breaking 141 at Lord's.**

Duckett's incredible innings helped England beat India by 27 runs in a thrilling series decider. It was a fantastic display of batting and a well-deserved series victory.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment of England's summer of cricket so far?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Ryan Fox has triumphed at a fiery Birkdale to win The Open, with his pacy play setting him apart from his peers.**

The New Zealander secured his first major of his career, amidst a tournament that saw some controversy. Fox's composed performance ultimately led him to victory.

ON AIR – Did you manage to catch any of The Open this year? What did you make of the action?

GOLF · UK

4 **Chelsea have made a significant move in the transfer market, signing Manchester United striker Melvine Malard for £850,000.**

The France international will link up with Chelsea manager Sonia Bompastor, who previously gave her debut at Lyon. It's a big signing for the Blues.

ON AIR – What do you think of Chelsea's latest signing? Do you think she'll make a big impact?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **The Hundred is set to kick off this Tuesday, with Manchester Super Giants seamer Grace Ballinger looking at a revamped tournament.**

Cricket fans are eagerly anticipating the start of the new season, with teams ready to battle it out for glory. It promises to be an exciting few weeks of action.

ON AIR – Are you excited for The Hundred to start? Which team are you backing this year?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people transforming forgotten garden sheds into stylish 'reading nooks' and 'hobby hubs'.**
It seems the humble garden shed is getting a glamorous makeover, with many finding joy in creating cosy, personalised spaces away from the main house. From mini art studios to quiet meditation zones, these garden hideaways are becoming highly sought-after.
- 2 Scientists have found that looking at photos of 'cute animals' can actually improve your concentration and performance on tasks.**
Next time you need a brain boost, try a quick scroll through some adorable puppies or kittens! Researchers discovered that a dose of cuteness helps us to be more careful and focused, which could be handy before a big meeting or a tricky crossword.
- 3 The delightful art of 'illustrated recipe cards' is making a charming comeback, with many preferring them to digital versions.**
Instead of screen-swiping through online instructions, people are embracing beautifully hand-drawn or painted recipe cards, often passed down through generations. It adds a lovely personal touch to cooking and makes a wonderful family heirloom.
- 4 A growing number of people are discovering the surprising satisfaction of 'tidying up public spaces' during their daily walks.**
It's a small act of kindness with a big impact! Individuals are voluntarily picking up litter or sprucing up local areas, finding a sense of community and personal pride in making their neighbourhoods a bit nicer for everyone.
- 5 Experts are suggesting that regularly 'changing the route of your daily walk' can boost creativity and mood.**
Breaking free from routine and exploring new paths, even if just a different side of the park, can stimulate your brain and offer fresh perspectives. It's a simple way to add a bit of adventure to your everyday.
- 6 The unexpected joy of 'writing letters to your future self' is becoming a popular way to reflect and set goals.**
Imagine opening a letter from five years ago, full of hopes and dreams! People are finding it a thoughtful exercise to document their current thoughts and aspirations, often with surprising and heartwarming results when they revisit them later.
- 7 A recent study highlights the positive impact of 'using colourful stationery' on workplace morale and productivity.**
It seems a splash of bright colours on your desk, from pens to notebooks, can make your workday feel a little more cheerful and engaging. It's a small change that can make a big difference to your daily outlook.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide if we've left the oven on?

ANSWER: ...A QUICK DASH BACK INSIDE JUST TO CHECK, EVEN IF YOU'RE ALREADY HALFWAY DOWN THE ROAD!

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down for a good night's sleep?

ANSWER: ...ENSURING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED UP AND ALIGNED, EVEN IF NO ONE ELSE IS GOING TO SEE THEM UNTIL MORNING!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you spot a 'familiar face' in an unexpected place, and it completely throws you off for a moment?**

Have you ever had that experience of seeing someone you know – maybe a distant relative, an old school friend, or even your neighbour – in a completely random location, like a different town, or abroad, and it just takes you by surprise? What's the most unexpected place you've bumped into someone you know?

- **We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that bring a surprising sense of calm or contentment, don't we?**

Think about those gentle, background noises that, for some reason, just make you feel a bit warm and fuzzy inside. Is it the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant sound of church bells, or perhaps the rustle of leaves outside your window? What's your go-to comforting everyday sound?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Before alarm clocks were widely available, there were 'knocker-uppers' in Britain who would tap on people's windows with long poles to wake them for work.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public clock tower in London was built during the reign of King Henry VIII and was famously powered by a series of very large waterwheels.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The iconic red telephone box was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is 9,000 years old and was found in Sweden.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions, a phenomenon known as the Mpemba effect.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.

On this day

Day 202 of the year, 163 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alberic Crescitelli; Christian feast day: Albert John Luthuli (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Arbogast; Christian feast day: Barhadbesciabas. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Cat Stevens, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1984 — Liam Ridgewell, English footballer
- 1990 — Jason Roy, South African-English cricketer
- 1992 — Da\$H, American rapper
- 1988 — Chris Mitchell, Scottish footballer (died 2016)
- 1989 — Jasmine Cephas Jones, English actress and singer
- 1981 — Blake Lewis, American musician, American Idol contestant
- 1970 — Michael Fitzpatrick, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1995 — Third Taiwan Strait Crisis: The People's Liberation Army begins firing missiles into the waters north of Taiwan.
- 1961 — Mercury program: Mercury-Redstone 4 Mission: Gus Grissom piloting Liberty Bell 7 becomes the second American to go into space (in a suborbital mission).
- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden announces he will no longer seek a second term and withdraws from the 2024 election, endorsing Vice President Kamala Harris as she launches her own presidential campaign.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 2010 — U.S. President Barack Obama signs the Dodd–Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2011 — NASA's Space Shuttle program ends with the landing of Space Shuttle Atlantis on mission STS-135 at NASA's Kennedy Space Center.

- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden announces he will no longer seek a second term and withdraws from the 2024 election, endorsing Vice President Kamala Harris as she launches her own presidential campaign.
- 1964 — A series of racial riots break out in Singapore. In the next six weeks, 23 die with 454 others injured.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 203 of the year, 162 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Anna Wang; Christian feast day: Mary Magdalene; Christian feast day: Markella. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1998 — Madison Pettis, American actress
- 1964 — David Spade, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Paul Schrader, American director and screenwriter
- 1960 — John Leguizamo, Colombian-American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Albert Brooks, American actor, comedian, director, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Danny Glover, American actor, director, and producer
- 1984 — Stewart Downing, English footballer
- 1951 — Tisa Farrow, American actress and model (died 2024)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — Mariner program: Mariner 1 spacecraft flies erratically several minutes after launch and has to be destroyed.
- 1951 — Soviet space dogs: Dezik and Tsygan were launched into a sub-orbital spaceflight from Kapustin Yar and became the first dogs to fly in space and the first to safely return.
- 1937 — New Deal: The United States Senate votes down President Franklin D. Roosevelt's proposal to add more justices to the Supreme Court of the United States.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1943 — World War II: Axis occupation forces violently disperse a massive protest in Athens, killing 22.
- 1937 — New Deal: The United States Senate votes down President Franklin D. Roosevelt's proposal to add more justices to the Supreme Court of the United States.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)